

2026 FIFA World Cup

The **2026 FIFA World Cup**^[A] was the 23rd FIFA World Cup, the quadrennial international men's soccer championship contested by the national teams of the member associations of FIFA. The tournament began on June 11, 2026, and concluded on July 19 with Spain winning the championship for the second time.^[3] It was jointly hosted by 16 cities—11 in the United States, 3 in Mexico, and 2 in Canada. The tournament was the first FIFA World Cup to be hosted by three countries and the first to include 48 teams, an expansion from the previous 32-team format.^[4]

The 2026 tournament was the second World Cup to be hosted by multiple nations, after the 2002 edition. Mexico became the first country to host the World Cup three times, having hosted the 1970 and 1986 tournaments.^[5] The United States previously hosted the World Cup in 1994, while it was Canada's first time hosting the tournament.^[5] The event returned to its traditional June–July schedule after the 2022 World Cup in Qatar, which was uniquely held in November and December to avoid Qatar's extreme summer heat.^[6] Canada, Mexico, and the United States qualified automatically as hosts, while Cape Verde, Curaçao, Jordan, and Uzbekistan made their World Cup debuts.^[5]

For the first time in the tournament's history, the top four teams from the FIFA Men's World Ranking at the time of the contest (Argentina, Spain, France, and England) advanced to the semifinals.^[7] Spain won the final against defending champion Argentina 1–0 after extra time, winning its second title and first since 2010. Spain also made history by being the first nation to become the reigning champion for both the men's and women's World Cups,^[8] and the first team to win the World Cup while conceding only one goal during the tournament. France captain Kylian Mbappé won his second consecutive Golden Boot for scoring the most goals (10) during the tournament. He became the all-time leading goalscorer at the World Cup and the first player to win multiple World Cup Golden Boots.^[9] The average number of goals per match in the tournament was 2.96, the highest since the 1970 edition.^[10]

Spain captain Rodri won the Golden Ball as the best player of the tournament. Unai Simón won the Golden Glove as the tournament's best goalkeeper, while Pau Cubarsí won the Young Player Award as the tournament's best young player. Nearly 7 million people attended matches during the tournament, surpassing the 1994 edition to set a new record for the highest attendance in World Cup history.^[11] The 2026 World Cup reportedly generated a record \$15 billion in revenue.^[12]

Format

Expansion

The idea of expanding the tournament had been suggested as early as 2013 by then-UEFA president Michel Platini,^{[13][14]} as well as in 2016 by current FIFA president Gianni Infantino.^[15] Opponents of the proposal argued that the number of matches played was already at an unacceptable level, that the expansion would dilute the quality of the matches,^{[16][17]} and that the decision was driven by political rather than sporting concerns, specifically that Infantino was trying to win his election by promising to bring more countries to the World Cup.^[18]

Starting with the 2026 edition, the World Cup expanded to 48 teams, an increase of 16 teams compared to the previous seven tournaments.^[19] As approved by the FIFA Council on March 14, 2023, the teams were split into 12 groups of 4 teams, with the top 2 teams in each group and the 8 best third-place teams progressing to a new round of 32.^[20] It was the first expansion and format change since 1998.^[21]

2026 FIFA World Cup

Coupe du Monde de la FIFA 2026 (French)
Copa Mundial de la FIFA 2026 (Spanish)



Tournament details

Host countries	Canada Mexico United States
Dates	June 11 – July 19
Teams	48 (from 6 confederations)
Venues	16 (in 16 host cities)

Final positions

Champions	 <u>Spain</u> (2nd title)
Runners-up	 <u>Argentina</u>
Third place	 <u>England</u>
Fourth place	 <u>France</u>

Tournament statistics

Matches played	104
Goals scored	308 (2.96 per match)
Attendance	6,810,966 (65,490 per match)
Top scorer	 <u>Kylian Mbappé</u> (10 goals)
Best player	 <u>Rodri</u>
Best young player	 <u>Pau Cubarsí</u>
Best goalkeeper	 <u>Unai Simón</u>
Fair play award	 <u>Netherlands</u>

← 2022 2030 →

The total number of matches played increased from 64 to 104, and the number of matches played by teams reaching the semifinals increased from 7 to 8. The tournament lasted 39 days, an increase from the 32 days of the 2014 and 2018 tournaments, and from the 29 days of the 2022 tournament,^{[22][23]} although each team still played three group matches.^{[24][25]} The final matchday at club level for players named in the final squads was May 24, 2026; clubs had to release their players by May 25, with exceptions granted to players participating in continental club competition finals up until May 30. The combined rest, release, and tournament periods remained 56 days, the same as in the 2010, 2014, and 2018 World Cups.^[20]

Other expansion formats explored

After the expansion to 48 teams was approved on January 10, 2017, it was initially decided that the tournament would include 16 groups of 3 teams, with the top two teams of each group progressing to a round of 32.^{[19][26]} This format would have included 80 matches in total, with the maximum number of matches per team remaining at seven, although each team would have played one fewer group match than in the 2022 tournament. The tournament would still have been completed within 32 days.^[27] This format was chosen over three alternatives involving 40 to 48 teams, 76 to 88 matches, and a minimum of 1 to 4 matches per team.^[B]

Critics of this format argued that the use of three-team groups with two teams progressing significantly increased the risk of collusion between teams.^[31] This prompted FIFA to suggest that penalty shootouts could be used to prevent draws in the group stage,^[32] although even then some risk of collusion would remain, as it was possible for the two teams playing the last group match to engineer a circle of death result that would allow both of them to qualify.^[31] The tournament format was finalized in 2023, with an announcement that there would be 12 groups of 4 teams.^{[33][34]}

New rules

The 2026 FIFA World Cup introduced several rule changes, primarily designed to reduce time-wasting.^[35] The new rules included:

- 10-second substitutions: Players being substituted had ten seconds to exit the field; otherwise, the substitute had to wait for one minute before entering the match.
- 5-second restarts: A visual 5-second countdown was shown by the referee for throw-ins and goal kicks in situations of time-wasting. If the ball was not put into play in time, a restart was awarded to the opposing team; a corner kick was awarded if the infraction occurred with a goal kick.
- Medical treatment: Any outfield player who received medical attention on the field had to leave the field and wait for 1 minute before returning to play.
- Expanded video assistant referee (VAR): The VAR could review and overturn wrongly awarded corner kicks, certain attacking fouls, and clear mistakes on red cards given from a second yellow card.
- Mouth-covering red cards: To stop confrontational or insulting behavior which was concealed to avoid lip-reading, any player who covered his mouth with his hand, arm, or shirt while confronting an opponent was sent off.
- Player leaving the field in protest: Players or officials who left the field in protest were sent off.^[35]

Another change was the tiebreaker formula used when two or more teams finish the group stage with an equal number of points. The first tiebreaker criteria was the number of points earned in head-to-head matches between the tied teams, not the goal difference among all matches.^[C]

Mandatory breaks

Cooling or hydration breaks were introduced at the 2014 World Cup in Brazil. For the 2026 World Cup, FIFA introduced mandatory three-minute hydration breaks in every half for all matches. Broadcasters were permitted to run commercials during these pauses.^[39] Since the clock did not stop during the breaks, the three minutes were automatically included in the stoppage time for each half.^[40]

Match schedule

The match schedule, without group assignments, was announced on February 4, 2024.^[D] On June 13, FIFA released an updated schedule, with specific pairings assigned to venues for the knockout stage.^[43] The full schedule was unveiled in a live broadcast on December 6, 2025, the day after the draw.^[44] The opening match of the tournament included Mexico, and took place on June 11, 2026, at the Estadio Azteca in Mexico City.^[45] Canada's first match occurred on June 12 at BMO Field in Toronto, while the United States' opening match took place on the same day at SoFi Stadium in Inglewood. The national team of each host nation played its three group stage matches in its own country.^[41]

AT&T Stadium in Arlington hosted the most matches of any venue, with nine. The U.S. hosted 78 matches, including all quarterfinals, semifinals, and the final, which was played at MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford on July 19. Canada and Mexico each hosted 13 matches. Each tournament venue, except for the Estadio Akron, hosted at least one knockout stage match.^[46] The match schedule

overlapped with the 2026 Canadian Football League season, resulting in scheduling conflicts and loss of home games for the Toronto Argonauts and BC Lions.^{[47][48]} The match schedule also affected the 2026 Major League Baseball season schedules of the Kansas City Royals, Philadelphia Phillies, Seattle Mariners, and Texas Rangers, with home stadiums near World Cup venues.^[49]

Host cities were geographically grouped into three regions:^[3]

- Western Region (Vancouver, Seattle, San Francisco Bay Area, Los Angeles)
- Central Region (Guadalajara, Mexico City, Monterrey, Houston, Dallas, Kansas City)
- Eastern Region (Atlanta, Miami, Toronto, Boston, Philadelphia, New York/New Jersey)

However, even during the group stage, about half of the teams had to play matches in two different regions.^[3]

Schedule by round			Schedule by group			
Stage	Matchday	Date	Matchday	Pairings	Groups	Date
Group	1	June 11–17	1	1 vs 2 3 vs 4	A	June 11
	2	June 18–23			B & D	June 12
	3	June 24–27			B, C & D	June 13
Knockout	Round of 32	June 28 – July 3			E & F	June 14
	Round of 16	July 4–7			G & H	June 15
	Quarterfinals	July 9–11			I & J	June 16
	Semifinals	July 14–15			K & L	June 17
	Match for third place	July 18	2	1 vs 3 4 vs 2	A & B	June 18
	Final	July 19			C & D	June 19
					E & F	June 20
					G & H	June 21
					I & J	June 22
					K & L	June 23
			3	4 vs 1 2 vs 3	A, B & C	June 24
					D, E & F	June 25
					G, H & I	June 26
					J, K & L	June 27

Host selection

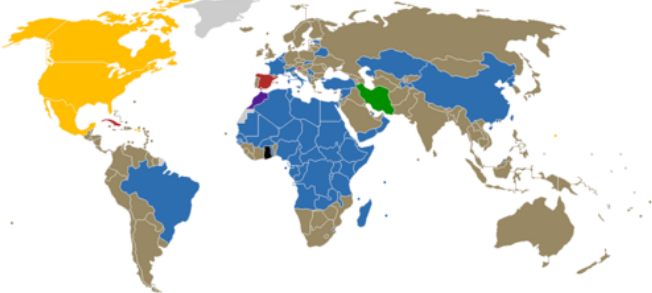
The United 2026 bid beat a rival bid by Morocco during a final vote at the 68th FIFA Congress in Moscow in 2018. The previous year, FIFA president Gianni Infantino had stated that Europe (UEFA confederation) and Asia (AFC) would be excluded from the bidding following the selection of Russia for the 2018 World Cup and Qatar for the 2022 tournament.^[50] Therefore, the 2026 World Cup could be hosted by one of the remaining four confederations: CONCACAF (North America; last hosted in 1994), CAF (Africa; last hosted in 2010), CONMEBOL (South America; last hosted in 2014), or OFC (Oceania, never hosted), or potentially by AFC or UEFA in case no bid from the others met FIFA's requirements.^[51]

Co-hosting of the World Cup—which had been suspended by FIFA after the 2002 edition—was approved for the enlarged 2026 tournament.^[52] Canada, Mexico, and the United States had each considered bidding for the tournament separately; the United joint bid was announced on April 10, 2017.^{[53][54]} The Moroccan bid was announced that August.^[55]

Voting

Voting for the host was open to 203 FIFA member associations.^[56] The United bid won with 134 votes, while the Morocco bid received 65 votes.^{[54][57]} Iran voted for neither of the two bids, while Cuba, Slovenia, and Spain abstained from voting. Ghana had been suspended by FIFA for corruption and was therefore ineligible to vote.^[E] Morocco was later selected as a co-host of the 2030 FIFA World Cup, alongside Portugal, Spain, Argentina, Paraguay, and Uruguay.

Voting results

Nation	Vote	Map
	Round 1	
Canada, Mexico, United States	134	
Morocco	65	
None of the bids	1	
Abstentions	3	
Total valid votes	200	Allowed to vote Voted for United bid Voted for Moroccan bid Voted for neither Abstained from voting Ineligible to vote Canada–Mexico–United States Morocco Sanctioned by FIFA Not a FIFA member
Required for majority	101	

Venues

During the bidding process, 41 cities with 42 existing, fully functional venues with regular tenants (except Olympic Stadium in Montreal) and two venues then under construction (Allegiant Stadium in Las Vegas and SoFi Stadium in Los Angeles) submitted to be part of the bid: three venues in three cities in Mexico, six venues in six cities in Canada, and 35 venues in 32 cities in the United States.^[63] A first-round elimination removed nine venues and nine cities. A second-round elimination cut an additional nine venues in six cities, while three venues in three cities (Soldier Field in Chicago, U.S. Bank Stadium in Minneapolis, and BC Place in Vancouver) dropped out because FIFA was unwilling to negotiate financial details.^[64] After Montreal dropped out in July 2021 because it lacked provincial funding and support to renovate Olympic Stadium,^[65] Vancouver rejoined the bid as a candidate city in April 2022,^[66] bringing the total number to 24 venues, each in its own city or metropolitan area.^[67]



On June 16, 2022, the sixteen host cities—two in Canada, three in Mexico, and eleven in the United States—were announced by FIFA: Atlanta, Boston, Dallas, Guadalajara, Houston, Kansas City, Los Angeles, Mexico City, Miami, Monterrey, New York/New Jersey, Philadelphia, San Francisco Bay Area, Seattle, Toronto, and Vancouver.^[68] Eight of the sixteen chosen stadiums had permanent artificial turf surfaces that were replaced with grass under the direction of FIFA and a University of Tennessee–Michigan State University research team. Depending on the venue's climate, the turf used was either a hybrid of 84% Kentucky bluegrass and 16% perennial ryegrass (for cooler temperatures), or Bermuda grass (for warmer temperatures).^{[69][70][71]}

Four venues (Atlanta, Dallas, Houston, and Vancouver) were indoor stadiums that used retractable roof systems, all equipped with climate control, while a fifth, SoFi Stadium in Los Angeles, was open-air but had a translucent roof and no climate control.^[72] The host of the final match—MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey—was announced by FIFA on February 4, 2024.^[73]

Although there were soccer-specific stadiums in Canada and the United States, the largest soccer-specific stadium in the U.S., Geodis Park in Nashville, Tennessee, seated 30,000, fell short of FIFA's minimum requirement of 40,000 seats (Toronto's BMO Field was expanded from 30,000 to 45,500 for this tournament).^[74] Stadiums including Mercedes-Benz Stadium in Atlanta; Gillette Stadium in Foxborough, Massachusetts; and Lumen Field in Seattle have been used by both National Football League (NFL) and Major League Soccer (MLS) teams.^[75] Although the Canadian and American stadiums were primarily used for gridiron football, they were also designed to accommodate soccer matches.^[76]

Mexico City was the only capital of the three host nations chosen as a venue site; Ottawa and Washington, D.C., joined Bonn (West Germany, 1974) and Tokyo (Japan, 2002) as the only capital cities not selected to host World Cup matches. Washington was a host city candidate, but the poor state of Northwest Stadium caused the city to combine its bid with nearby Baltimore's M&T Bank Stadium, which was unsuccessful. Other cities eliminated from the final hosting list were Cincinnati, Denver, Nashville, Orlando, and Edmonton.

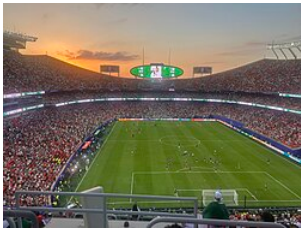
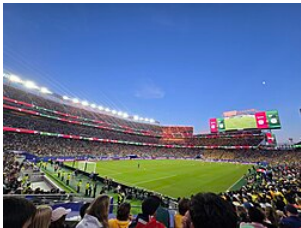
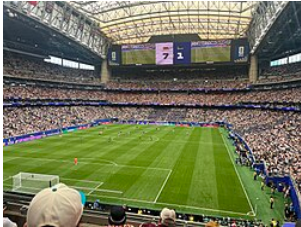
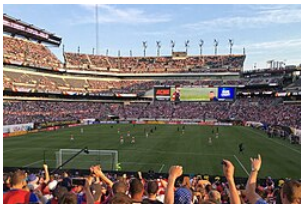
Ottawa's candidate venue, TD Place Stadium, was eliminated early on for insufficient capacity.^[77] Eight of the metropolitan areas involved had previously hosted World Cup matches (Dallas, Los Angeles, San Francisco Bay Area, New York/New Jersey, and Boston in 1994; Guadalajara and Mexico City in both 1970 and 1986; Monterrey in 1986), but none of the stadiums used in the 1994 FIFA World Cup were used in this tournament (though Gillette Stadium and MetLife Stadium were located at the same sites as two of the 1994 venues, Foxboro Stadium and Giants Stadium respectively).^[78] Soldier Field in Chicago, the Cotton Bowl in Dallas, and the Rose Bowl in Pasadena (Los Angeles area) were the only stadiums in the bidding process to have hosted matches in 1994, but none of them were selected.^[63] Estadio Azteca in Mexico City was the only stadium in this tournament that had previously been used for a World Cup, in both 1970 and 1986; it thus became the only stadium to be used for three World Cups.

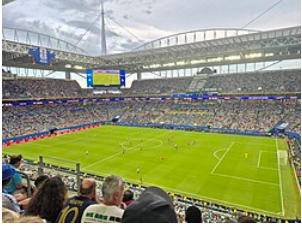
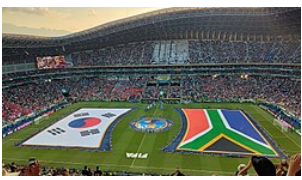
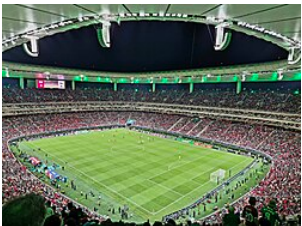
FIFA's rules on stadium sponsorships required venues to use alternative names for the duration of the tournament, shown in parentheses below.^{[F][79][80]} The capacity is based on information published by FIFA.^[80]

Key

- † denotes a stadium used for previous men's World Cup tournaments.
- ‡ denotes an indoor stadium with a fixed or retractable roof with interior climate control.

List of tournament venues

City ^[G]	Stadium	Number of matches	Capacity	Image
 Mexico City	Estadio Azteca [†] (Mexico City Stadium) ^[E]	5 (3 group, 2 knockout)	80,824	
 New York/New Jersey (East Rutherford, New Jersey)	MetLife Stadium (New York New Jersey Stadium)	8 (5 group, 2 knockout, and the final)	80,663	
 Dallas (Arlington, Texas)	AT&T Stadium [‡] (Dallas Stadium)	9 (5 group, 4 knockout)	70,649	
 Los Angeles (Inglewood, California)	SoFi Stadium [‡] (Los Angeles Stadium)	8 (5 group, 3 knockout)	70,492	
 Kansas City	Arrowhead Stadium (Kansas City Stadium) ^[E]	6 (4 group, 2 knockout)	69,045	
 San Francisco Bay Area (Santa Clara, California)	Levi's Stadium (San Francisco Bay Area Stadium)	6 (5 group, 1 knockout)	68,827	
 Houston	NRG Stadium [‡] (Houston Stadium)	7 (5 group, 2 knockout)	68,777	
 Philadelphia	Lincoln Financial Field (Philadelphia Stadium)	6 (5 group, 1 knockout)	68,324	

 Atlanta	<u>Mercedes-Benz Stadium†</u> (Atlanta Stadium)	8 (5 group, 3 knockout)	68,239	
 Seattle	Lumen Field (Seattle Stadium)	6 (4 group, 2 knockout)	66,925	
 Miami (Miami Gardens, Florida)	<u>Hard Rock Stadium</u> (Miami Stadium)	7 (4 group, 2 knockout, and third-place)	64,478	
 Boston (Foxborough, Massachusetts)	<u>Gillette Stadium</u> (Boston Stadium)	7 (5 group, 2 knockout)	64,146	
 Vancouver	<u>BC Place†</u> (BC Place Vancouver)	7 (5 group, 2 knockout)	52,497	
 Monterrey (Guadalupe, Nuevo León)	<u>Estadio BBVA</u> (Estadio Monterrey)	4 (3 group, 1 knockout)	51,243	
 Guadalajara (Zapopan, Jalisco)	<u>Estadio Akron</u> (Estadio Guadalajara)	4 (4 group)	45,664	
 Toronto	<u>BMO Field</u> (Toronto Stadium)	6 (5 group, 1 knockout)	43,036	

Teams

Qualification

On August 31, 2022, FIFA president Gianni Infantino confirmed that six CONCACAF teams would qualify for the World Cup, with Canada, Mexico, and the United States automatically qualifying as hosts.^{[81][82]} This was confirmed by the [FIFA Council](#) on February 14, 2023.^{[83][84]}

Immediately prior to the 67th [FIFA Congress](#), the FIFA Council approved the slot allocation during a meeting in [Manama, Bahrain](#).^{[85][86]} This included an [inter-confederation playoff tournament](#) involving six teams to decide the last two FIFA World Cup spots.^[87] The six teams in the playoffs comprised one team from each confederation excluding [UEFA](#), and one additional team from the confederation of the host countries ([CONCACAF](#)). Two of those teams were seeded based on the [World Rankings](#), and they played the winners of two knockout matches between the four unseeded teams for the two FIFA World Cup berths. The four-match tournament was played in Mexico, one of the host countries, and was also used as a test event for the FIFA World Cup.^[85]

The ratification of slot allocation also gave the [OFC](#) a guaranteed berth in the final tournament for the first time: the 2026 FIFA World Cup was the first tournament in which all six confederations had at least one guaranteed berth and also the first time since the [2010 edition](#) in which all confederations had a team qualify for the World Cup finals.^[85]

Of the 48 qualified teams, 26 also appeared in the [2022 edition](#). Highlights include:

- [Cape Verde](#),^[88] [Curaçao](#),^[89] [Jordan](#), and [Uzbekistan](#)^{[H][90]} made their World Cup debuts.
- [Qatar](#) qualified for the tournament through qualification for the first time, as its only previous appearance was as host in 2022.^[91]
- [DR Congo](#)^[I] and [Haiti](#) returned to the tournament after appearing in their only previous tournament in 1974.^{[89][92]}
- [Iraq](#) returned to the tournament after appearing in its only previous tournament in 1986.^[93]
- [Austria](#), [Norway](#),^[94] and [Scotland](#) returned to the tournament after last appearing in 1998.^[95]

Four-time champion [Italy](#) failed to qualify after losing the [European playoff final](#) to Bosnia and Herzegovina on penalties, becoming the first former champion to miss three consecutive World Cups,^[96] as in 2018 and 2022, Italy was the only former champion that did not qualify. With a [FIFA Men's World Ranking](#) of 12, Italy was also the highest-ranking team that did not qualify.^[97]

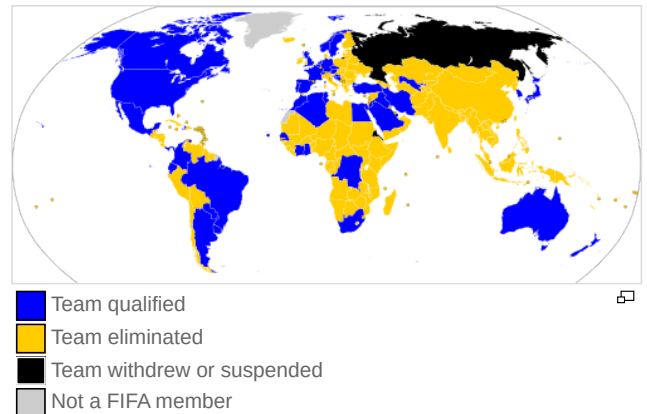
The qualified teams, listed by region, with numbers in parentheses indicating final positions in the FIFA Men's World Ranking before the tournament were:^[98]

AFC (9)

-  [Australia](#) (27)
-  [Iran](#)^[J] (20)
-  [Iraq](#) (57)
-  [Japan](#) (18)
-  [Jordan](#) (63; debut)
-  [Qatar](#) (56)
-  [Saudi Arabia](#) (61)
-  [South Korea](#)^[K] (25)
-  [Uzbekistan](#) (50; debut)

CAF (10)

-  [Algeria](#) (28)
-  [Cape Verde](#)^[L] (67; debut)
-  [DR Congo](#)^[M] (46)



-  [Egypt](#) (29)
-  [Ghana](#) (73)
-  [Ivory Coast](#)^[N] (33)
-  [Morocco](#) (7)
-  [Senegal](#) (15)
-  [South Africa](#) (60)
-  [Tunisia](#) (45)

CONCACAF (6)

-  [Canada](#) (30; co-host)
-  [Curaçao](#) (82; debut)
-  [Haiti](#) (83)
-  [Mexico](#) (14; co-host)
-  [Panama](#) (34)
-  [United States](#)^[O] (17; co-host)

CONMEBOL (6)

-  [Argentina](#) (1)
-  [Brazil](#) (6)
-  [Colombia](#) (13)
-  [Ecuador](#) (23)
-  [Paraguay](#) (41)
-  [Uruguay](#) (16)

OFC (1)

-  [New Zealand](#) (85)

UEFA (16)

-  [Austria](#) (24)
-  [Belgium](#) (9)
-  [Bosnia and Herzegovina](#) (64)
-  [Croatia](#) (11)
-  [Czech Republic](#)^[P] (40)
-  [England](#) (4)
-  [France](#) (3)
-  [Germany](#) (10)
-  [Netherlands](#) (8)
-  [Norway](#) (31)
-  [Portugal](#) (5)
-  [Scotland](#) (42)
-  [Spain](#) (2)
-  [Sweden](#) (38)
-  [Switzerland](#) (19)
-  [Turkey](#)^[Q] (22)

Draw

The draw took place on December 5, 2025, at the [Kennedy Center](#) in [Washington, D.C.](#)^[99] The draw ceremony began with FIFA presenting the first [FIFA Peace Prize](#) to [Donald Trump](#),^[100] an award which fueled scrutiny and controversy among human rights groups, analysts, and others.^{[101][102][103][104]}

The 48 teams were divided into four pots of 12. Pot 1 consisted of the three hosts and the top nine teams from the November 2025 [FIFA Men's World Ranking](#). Pots 2, 3, and 4 consisted of the remaining teams according to the ranking. The four winners of the [UEFA playoffs](#) and the two winners of the inter-confederation playoffs were not known at the time of the draw and thus were automatically allocated to Pot 4. The 12 groups were randomly formed by selecting one team from each of the four pots. With the exception of UEFA, no group could have more than one team from the same confederation drawn into it.^{[105][106]}

The three host nations were pre-allocated to three groups for scheduling purposes. Mexico was placed in Group A, Canada in Group B, and the United States in Group D.^{[3][107]}

The confederation restriction applied to all three potential winners of the inter-confederation playoffs. FIFA also announced that, "in the interest of ensuring competitive balance", the teams ranked first (Spain), second (Argentina), third (France), and fourth (England) would be drawn into opposite pathways. Therefore, should these teams win their groups, they would be unable to meet until the semifinals, and the first and second ranked teams would be unable to meet until the final.^[108] The draw started with Pot 1 and ended with Pot 4, with each team selected and then allocated into the first available group alphabetically. For the purpose of the match schedule, the Pot 1 teams were automatically drawn into position 1 of each group. For the remaining pots, FIFA established a predetermined pattern to define the position of teams based on their pot and the group they were drawn into.



From left to right, FIFA president Gianni Infantino, U.S. president Donald Trump, Mexican president Claudia Sheinbaum, and Canadian prime minister Mark Carney at the start of the draw.

Pots ^[R]			
Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3	Pot 4
1. United States (<i>co-host</i>) (14) 2. Mexico (<i>co-host</i>) (15) 3. Canada (<i>co-host</i>) (27) 4. Spain (1) 5. Argentina (2) 6. France (3) 7. England (4) 8. Brazil (5) 9. Portugal (6) 10. Netherlands (7) 11. Belgium (8) 12. Germany (9)	13. Croatia (10) 14. Morocco (11) 15. Colombia (13) 16. Uruguay (16) 17. Switzerland (17) 18. Japan (18) 19. Senegal (19) 20. Iran (20) 21. South Korea (22) 22. Ecuador (23) 23. Austria (24) 24. Australia (26)	25. Norway (29) 26. Panama (30) 27. Egypt (34) 28. Algeria (35) 29. Scotland (36) 30. Paraguay (39) 31. Tunisia (40) 32. Ivory Coast (42) 33. Uzbekistan (50) 34. Qatar (51) 35. Saudi Arabia (60) 36. South Africa (61)	37. Jordan (66) 38. Cape Verde (68) 39. Ghana (72) 40. Curaçao (82) 41. Haiti (84) 42. New Zealand (86) 43. UEFA Path A winner^[S] 44. UEFA Path B winner^[S] 45. UEFA Path C winner^[S] 46. UEFA Path D winner^[S] 47. IC Path 1 winner^{[S][T]} 48. IC Path 2 winner^{[S][U]}

Team base camps

Each of the 48 teams established a "base camp", where they stayed and trained before and during the World Cup.^[V]

Squads

Before submitting their final squad for the World Cup, teams named a provisional squad of between 35 and 55 players one month prior to the tournament. Teams were required to name their final squads by June 2. If a player became too injured or ill to participate in the tournament, he could be replaced by another player from the provisional squad until 24 hours before the team's first match. However, an injured or ill goalkeeper could be replaced by another goalkeeper from the provisional squad at any time during the tournament.^[114]

Travel distances

Teams participating in the 2026 World Cup had to travel an average of 5,146 total miles (8,281.7 km) between venues during the tournament. For the 2014 tournament in Brazil, the average distance was 7,054 miles (11,352.2 km), while teams playing in the 2018 tournament in Russia traveled an average of 5,441 miles (8,756.4 km).^[115]

Officiating

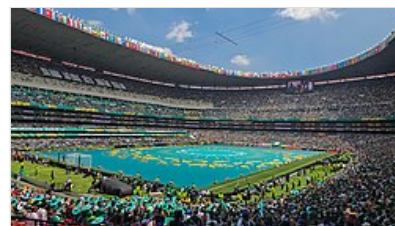
On April 9, 2026, FIFA announced 52 referees, 88 assistant referees, and 30 video assistant referees for the tournament.^{[116][117]} The 2026 World Cup featured six female match officials, equalling the record for the highest number of female officials appointed to a men's World Cup.^{[118][119]} Tori Penso, Brooke Mayo, and Kathryn Nesbitt became the second all-female on-field refereeing trio at a men's World Cup, officiating the Group A match between Czech Republic and South Africa at Atlanta Stadium.^[120]

On June 9, Somali referee Omar Artan was refused entry into the United States despite holding valid travel documents, and FIFA later removed him from the list of referees.^[121] FIFA stated that Artan would receive his full World Cup salary despite not being able to officiate in the tournament.^[122]

Ceremonies

Opening ceremonies

The tournament featured three opening ceremonies, one for each of the hosts.^[123] The opening ceremony in Mexico took place on June 11, 2026, at Estadio Azteca.^[124] Mexican singer Alejandro Fernández performed "Himno Nacional Mexicano" and South African singer Tyla performed the "National Anthem of South Africa".^[125] On June 12, the Canadian opening ceremony took place at BMO Field in Toronto. Canadian-American musician Alanis Morissette performed "O Canada" while Serbian-Canadian violinist Aleksandar Gajić performed "Državna himna Bosne i Hercegovine".^[126] On the same day, the opening ceremony in the United States took place at SoFi Stadium in Los Angeles. American country duo Dan + Shay performed "The Star-Spangled Banner" while Paraguayan soul duo Purahei Soul performed "Himno Nacional Paraguayo".^[127]



Inside Estadio Azteca during the Mexican opening ceremony prior to the first match of the 2026 FIFA World Cup. ⁵¹

1,000th FIFA World Cup match

The Group F game between Tunisia and Japan, played at Estadio BBVA in Monterrey on June 20, was the 1,000th match in FIFA World Cup history. To mark the occasion, FIFA organized a special pre-match ceremony. Princess Takamado, the Honorary Patron of the Japan Football Association (JFA), attended the event as a special guest.^[128] Japan won the match 4–0, securing its place in the knockout stage, while Tunisia suffered its second consecutive defeat and was eliminated from the tournament.^[129]

Independence Day ceremonies

On July 4, ceremonies took place at Lincoln Financial Field in Philadelphia (Paraguay vs France match) and NRG Stadium in Houston (Canada vs Morocco match) to honor the United States Semiquincentennial.^[130] The Houston ceremony featured pyrotechnics, video-board graphics, and a performance of "The Star-Spangled Banner" by United States Navy Band Chief Musician Maia Rodriguez. The Philadelphia ceremony featured pyrotechnics, video-board signage, and a performance of "The Star-Spangled Banner" by Idina Menzel, as well as musical performances by the Roots, ceremonial elements featuring the Philadelphia Boys Choir & Chorale and Miss Pennsylvania, Stephanie Skinner, a card stunt, a flyby of VFA-11 and VFA-81 squadrons from Naval Air Station Oceana, and a halftime show from DJ Jazzy Jeff.^[131]

Closing ceremony

The closing ceremony took place before the World Cup final at MetLife Stadium in New Jersey, and featured performances by Laura Pausini, Nicole Scherzinger, Robbie Williams, IShowSpeed, and Post Malone, as well as an appearance from Tom Cruise. Jennifer Hudson performed "The Star-Spangled Banner".^{[132][133]}



The World Cup final halftime show at MetLife Stadium ⁵¹

Final halftime show

The final match featured the first-ever Super Bowl-style halftime show in FIFA World Cup history. Madonna, Shakira, and BTS headlined the 11-minute halftime show, which was curated by Chris Martin of Coldplay and produced by Global Citizen.^{[134][135]} Justin Bieber, Burna Boy, Gustavo Dudamel, the Muppets, and the PS22 Chorus (featuring Coldplay) also performed in the show.^{[136][137]}

Group stage

The round-robin group stage was played in twelve groups (A to L) of four teams each, from June 11 to June 27.^[138] Teams were awarded three points for a win, one for a draw, and none for a loss. Following the conclusion of group play, the top two teams of each group, along with the eight best third-place teams, advanced to the knockout stage.

All times are local.

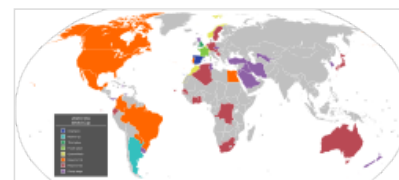
Tie-breaking criteria for group stage ranking

The ranking of teams in each group was determined by the points obtained in all group matches. If two or more teams were equal on points, the following criteria were used to determine the ranking:^[139]

- Most points obtained in the group matches played between the teams concerned;
- Superior goal difference in the group matches played between the teams concerned;
- Most goals scored in the group matches played between the teams concerned;

If, after having applied criteria a to c, teams still had an equal ranking, criteria a to c were reapplied exclusively to the matches between the teams who were still level to determine their final rankings.^[W] If this procedure did not lead to a decision, criteria d to h applied.

- Superior goal difference in all group matches;
- Most goals scored in all group matches;
- Highest team conduct ("fair play") score in all group matches (only one deduction could be applied to a player or team coach/official in a single match):
 - Yellow card: -1 point;
 - Indirect red card (second yellow card): -3 points;
 - Direct red card: -4 points;
 - Yellow card and direct red card: -5 points;
- Better position in the most recent FIFA Men's World Ranking;
- Better position in progressively older FIFA Men's World Rankings until teams could be separated.



Result of countries participating in the 2026 FIFA World Cup

Champion	Quarterfinals
Runner-up	Round of 16
Third place	Round of 32
Fourth place	Group stage

Group A

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Mexico (H)	3	3	0	0	6	0	+6	9	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	South Africa	3	1	1	1	2	3	-1	4	
3	South Korea	3	1	0	2	2	3	-1	3	
4	Czech Republic	3	0	1	2	2	6	-4	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

(H) Hosts

June 11, 2026

Mexico	2-0	South Africa	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
South Korea	2-1	Czech Republic	Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 18, 2026

Czech Republic	1-1	South Africa	Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Mexico	1-0	South Korea	Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 24, 2026

Czech Republic	0-3	Mexico	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
South Africa	1-0	South Korea	Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe

Group B

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Switzerland	3	2	1	0	7	3	+4	7	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	Canada (H)	3	1	1	1	8	3	+5	4 ^[a]	
3	Bosnia and Herzegovina	3	1	1	1	5	6	-1	4 ^[a]	
4	Qatar	3	0	1	2	2	10	-8	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

(H) Hosts

Notes:

- Tied on head-to-head result (Canada 1-1 Bosnia and Herzegovina). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 12, 2026

Canada	1-1	Bosnia and Herzegovina	BMO Field, Toronto
--------	-----	------------------------	--------------------

June 13, 2026

Qatar 

1–1

 Switzerland

Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

June 18, 2026

Switzerland 
Canada 

4–1
6–0

 Bosnia and Herzegovina
 Qatar

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
BC Place, Vancouver

June 24, 2026

Switzerland 
Bosnia and Herzegovina 

2–1
3–1

 Canada
 Qatar

BC Place, Vancouver
Lumen Field, Seattle

Group C

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 <u>Brazil</u>	3	2	1	0	7	1	+6	7 ^[a]	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 <u>Morocco</u>	3	2	1	0	6	3	+3	7 ^[a]	
3	 <u>Scotland</u>	3	1	0	2	1	4	–3	3	
4	 <u>Haiti</u>	3	0	0	3	2	8	–6	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

Notes:

- a. Tied on head-to-head result (Brazil 1–1 Morocco). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 13, 2026

Brazil 
Haiti 

1–1
0–1

 Morocco
 Scotland

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Gillette Stadium, Foxborough

June 19, 2026

Scotland 
Brazil 

0–1
3–0

 Morocco
 Haiti

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia

June 24, 2026

Scotland 
Morocco 

0–3
4–2

 Brazil
 Haiti

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group D

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 <u>United States (H)</u>	3	2	0	1	8	4	+4	6	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 <u>Australia</u>	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4 ^[a]	
3	 <u>Paraguay</u>	3	1	1	1	2	4	–2	4 ^[a]	
4	 <u>Turkey</u>	3	1	0	2	3	5	–2	3	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

(H) Hosts

Notes:

- a. Tied on head-to-head result (Paraguay 0–0 Australia). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 12, 2026

United States 

4–1

 Paraguay

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood

June 13, 2026

Australia 

2–0

 Turkey

BC Place, Vancouver

June 19, 2026

United States 
Turkey 

2–0
0–1

 Australia
 Paraguay

Lumen Field, Seattle
Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

June 25, 2026

Turkey 
Paraguay 

3–2
0–0

 United States
 Australia

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

Group E

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Germany	3	2	0	1	10	4	+6	6 ^[a]	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	Ivory Coast	3	2	0	1	4	2	+2	6 ^[a]	
3	Ecuador	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4	
4	Curaçao	3	0	1	2	1	9	-8	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

Notes:

a. Head-to-head result: Germany 2–1 Ivory Coast.

June 14, 2026

<u>Germany</u>	7–1	<u>Curaçao</u>	<u>NRG Stadium, Houston</u>
<u>Ivory Coast</u>	1–0	<u>Ecuador</u>	<u>Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia</u>

June 20, 2026

<u>Germany</u>	2–1	<u>Ivory Coast</u>	<u>BMO Field, Toronto</u>
<u>Ecuador</u>	0–0	<u>Curaçao</u>	<u>Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City</u>

June 25, 2026

<u>Curaçao</u>	0–2	<u>Ivory Coast</u>	<u>Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia</u>
<u>Ecuador</u>	2–1	<u>Germany</u>	<u>MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford</u>

Group F

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Netherlands	3	2	1	0	10	4	+6	7	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	Japan	3	1	2	0	7	3	+4	5	
3	Sweden	3	1	1	1	7	7	0	4	
4	Tunisia	3	0	0	3	2	12	-10	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 14, 2026

<u>Netherlands</u>	2–2	<u>Japan</u>	<u>AT&T Stadium, Arlington</u>
<u>Sweden</u>	5–1	<u>Tunisia</u>	<u>Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe</u>

June 20, 2026

<u>Netherlands</u>	5–1	<u>Sweden</u>	<u>NRG Stadium, Houston</u>
<u>Tunisia</u>	0–4	<u>Japan</u>	<u>Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe</u>

June 25, 2026

<u>Japan</u>	1–1	<u>Sweden</u>	<u>AT&T Stadium, Arlington</u>
<u>Tunisia</u>	1–3	<u>Netherlands</u>	<u>Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City</u>

Group G

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Belgium	3	1	2	0	6	2	+4	5 ^[a]	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	Egypt	3	1	2	0	5	3	+2	5 ^[a]	
3	Iran	3	0	3	0	3	3	0	3	
4	New Zealand	3	0	1	2	4	10	-6	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

Notes:

a. Tied on head-to-head result (Belgium 1–1 Egypt). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 15, 2026

<u>Belgium</u>	1–1	<u>Egypt</u>	<u>Lumen Field, Seattle</u>
<u>Iran</u>	2–2	<u>New Zealand</u>	<u>SoFi Stadium, Inglewood</u>

June 21, 2026

<u>Belgium</u>	0–0	<u>Iran</u>	<u>SoFi Stadium, Inglewood</u>
<u>New Zealand</u>	1–3	<u>Egypt</u>	<u>BC Place, Vancouver</u>

June 26, 2026

Egypt 
New Zealand 

1–1
1–5

Iran 
Belgium 

Lumen Field, Seattle
BC Place, Vancouver

Group H

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Spain	3	2	1	0	5	0	+5	7	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Cape Verde	3	0	3	0	2	2	0	3	
3	 Uruguay	3	0	2	1	3	4	–1	2 ^[a]	
4	 Saudi Arabia	3	0	2	1	1	5	–4	2 ^[a]	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

Notes:

- a. Tied on head-to-head result (Saudi Arabia 1–1 Uruguay). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 15, 2026

Spain 
Saudi Arabia 

0–0
1–1

 Cape Verde
 Uruguay

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 21, 2026

Spain 
Uruguay 

4–0
2–2

 Saudi Arabia
 Cape Verde

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens

June 26, 2026

Cape Verde 
Uruguay 

0–0
0–1

 Saudi Arabia
 Spain

NRG Stadium, Houston
Estadio Akron, Zapopan

Group I

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 France	3	3	0	0	10	2	+8	9	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Norway	3	2	0	1	8	7	+1	6	
3	 Senegal	3	1	0	2	8	6	+2	3	
4	 Iraq	3	0	0	3	1	12	–11	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 16, 2026

France 
Iraq 

3–1
1–4

 Senegal
 Norway

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Gillette Stadium, Foxborough

June 22, 2026

France 
Norway 

3–0
3–2

 Iraq
 Senegal

Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford

June 26, 2026

Norway 
Senegal 

1–4
5–0

 France
 Iraq

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
BMO Field, Toronto

Group J

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Argentina	3	3	0	0	8	1	+7	9	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Austria	3	1	1	1	6	6	0	4 ^[a]	
3	 Algeria	3	1	1	1	5	7	–2	4 ^[a]	
4	 Jordan	3	0	0	3	3	8	–5	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

Notes:

- a. Tied on head-to-head result (Algeria 3–3 Austria). Overall goal difference was used as the tiebreaker.

June 16, 2026

Argentina  3–0  Algeria
Austria  3–1  Jordan

Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

June 22, 2026

Argentina  2–0  Austria
Jordan  1–2  Algeria

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara

June 27, 2026

Algeria  3–3  Austria
Jordan  1–3  Argentina

Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
AT&T Stadium, Arlington

Group K

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Colombia	3	2	1	0	4	1	+3	7	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Portugal	3	1	2	0	6	1	+5	5	
3	 DR Congo	3	1	1	1	4	3	+1	4	
4	 Uzbekistan	3	0	0	3	2	11	−9	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 17, 2026

Portugal  1–1  DR Congo
Uzbekistan  1–3  Colombia

NRG Stadium, Houston
Estadio Azteca, Mexico City

June 23, 2026

Portugal  5–0  Uzbekistan
Colombia  1–0  DR Congo

NRG Stadium, Houston
Estadio Akron, Zapopan

June 27, 2026

Colombia  0–0  Portugal
DR Congo  3–1  Uzbekistan

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

Group L

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 England	3	2	1	0	6	2	+4	7	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	 Croatia	3	2	0	1	5	5	0	6	
3	 Ghana	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4	
4	 Panama	3	0	0	3	0	4	−4	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)

June 17, 2026

England  4–2  Croatia
Ghana  1–0  Panama

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
BMO Field, Toronto

June 23, 2026

England  0–0  Ghana
Panama  0–1  Croatia

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
BMO Field, Toronto

June 27, 2026

Panama  0–2  England
Croatia  2–1  Ghana

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia

Ranking of third-place teams

Pos	Grp	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	K	DR Congo	3	1	1	1	4	3	+1	4	Advance to <u>knockout stage</u>
2	F	Sweden	3	1	1	1	7	7	0	4	
3	L	Ghana	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4 ^[a]	
4	E	Ecuador	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4 ^[a]	
5	B	Bosnia and Herzegovina	3	1	1	1	5	6	−1	4	
6	J	Algeria	3	1	1	1	5	7	−2	4	
7	D	Paraguay	3	1	1	1	2	4	−2	4	
8	I	Senegal	3	1	0	2	8	6	+2	3	
9	G	Iran	3	0	3	0	3	3	0	3	
10	A	South Korea	3	1	0	2	2	3	−1	3	
11	C	Scotland	3	1	0	2	1	4	−3	3	
12	H	Uruguay	3	0	2	1	3	4	−1	2	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/standings>)
Rules for classification: 1) Points; 2) Goal difference; 3) Goals scored; 4) Team conduct ("fair play") score; 5) Latest FIFA ranking (June 11, 2026); 6) Previous FIFA ranking(s) report.
Notes:

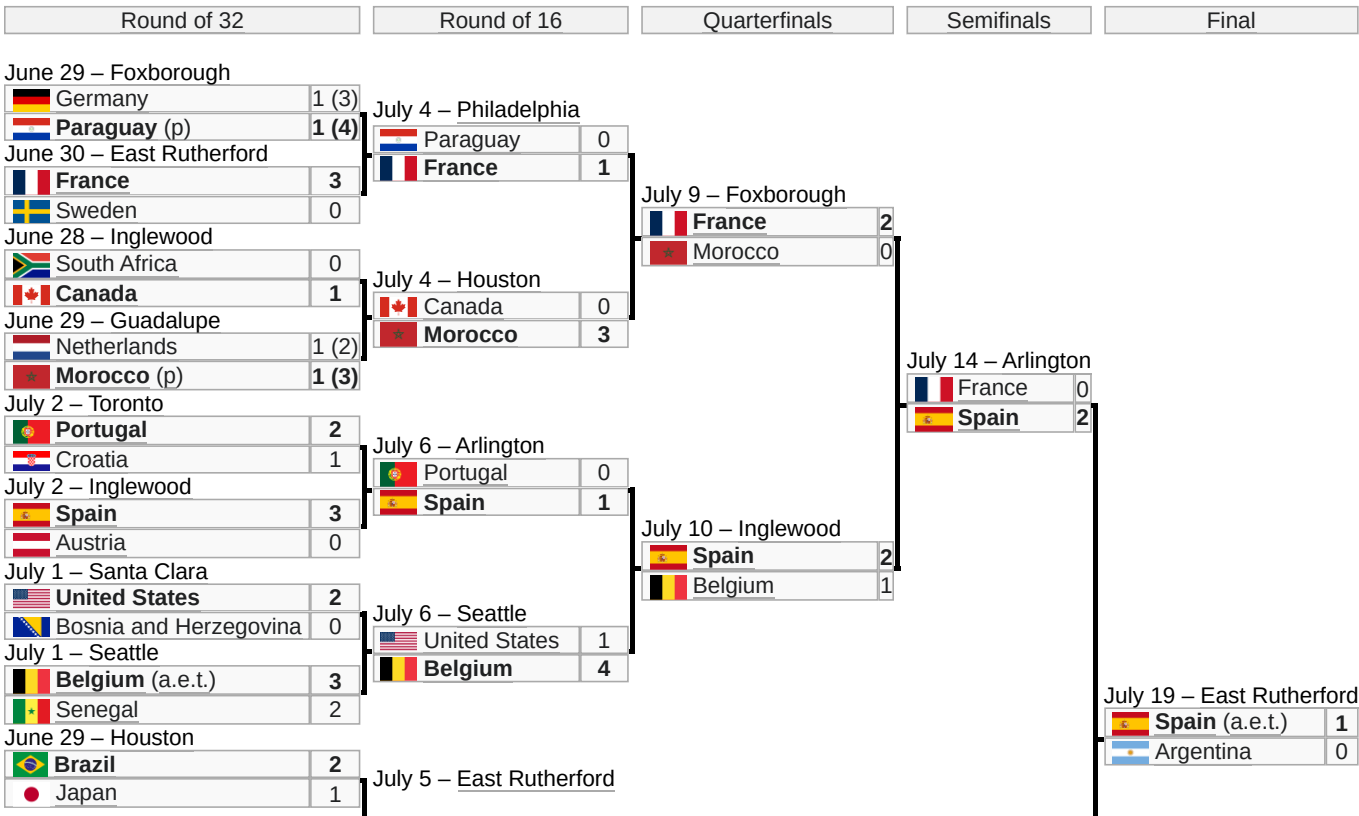
a. Team conduct score: Ghana −3, Ecuador −5.

The specific matchups involving the third-place teams depended on which eight third-place teams qualified for the round of 32, but not on their relative rankings. The 495 possible combinations were published in Annex C of the tournament regulations. Because of the specific combination of qualified teams, option number 67 of annex C was applicable.^[139]

Knockout stage

The knockout stage used a single-elimination format, starting with the newly introduced round of 32 on June 28 and culminating with the final on July 19, with a match for third place the day before. If the score was even after regulation time in a match, 30 minutes of extra time were added. If still tied after this, a penalty shootout determined the winner.^[139]

Bracket



June 30 – Arlington		Brazil	1		
Ivory Coast	1	Norway	2	July 11 – Miami Gardens	
Norway	2			Norway	1
June 30 – Mexico City				England (a.e.t.)	2
Mexico	2	July 5 – Mexico City			
Ecuador	0	Mexico	2		
July 1 – Atlanta		England	3		
England	2				
DR Congo	1				
July 3 – Miami Gardens					
Argentina (a.e.t.)	3	July 7 – Atlanta		July 15 – Atlanta	
Cape Verde	2	Argentina	3	England	1
July 3 – Arlington		Egypt	2	Argentina	2
Australia	1 (2)			Match for third place	
Egypt (p)	1 (4)			July 18 – Miami Gardens	
July 2 – Vancouver				France	4
Switzerland	2	July 7 – Vancouver		England	6
Algeria	0	Switzerland (p)	0 (4)		
July 3 – Kansas City		Colombia	0 (3)		
Colombia	1				
Ghana	0				

Round of 32

June 28, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

South Africa	0-1	Canada
	[Report 1]	Eustáquio ⚽ 90+2'

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
Attendance: 69,237
Referee: João Pinheiro (Portugal)

June 29, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-5

Brazil	2-1	Japan
Casemiro ⚽ 56'	[Report 2]	Sano ⚽ 29'
Martinelli ⚽ 90+5'		

NRG Stadium, Houston
Attendance: 68,777
Referee: Maurizio Mariani (Italy)

June 29, 2026
4:30 p.m. UTC-4

Germany	1-1 (a.e.t.)	Paraguay
Havertz ⚽ 54'	[Report 3]	Enciso ⚽ 42'
Penalties		
3-4		
Havertz ❌		⚽ Maurício
Kimmich ⚽		⚽ G. Gómez
Musiala ⚽		⚽ Galarza
Woltemade ❌		❌ Sanabria
Amiri ⚽		❌ Balbuena
Tah ❌		⚽ Canale

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
Attendance: 63,945
Referee: Jalal Jayed (Morocco)

June 29, 2026
7:00 p.m. UTC-6

Netherlands	1-1 (a.e.t.)	Morocco
Gakpo ⚽ 72'	[Report 4]	Diop ⚽ 90+1'
Penalties		
2-3		
Koopmeiners ⚽		❌ El Aynaoui
Kluivert ❌		⚽ Rahimi

Weghorst 🇬🇧
Timber 🇳🇱
Summerville 🇺🇸

Talbi 🇩🇪
Hakimi 🇩🇪
Saibari 🇩🇪

Estadio BBVA, Guadalupe
Attendance: 51,243
Referee: Wilton Sampaio (Brazil)

June 30, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-5

Ivory Coast 🇳🇬
Diallo ⚽ 74'

1-2
[Report 5]

Norway 🇳🇴
Nusa ⚽ 39'
Haaland ⚽ 86'

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
Attendance: 69,665
Referee: Jesús Valenzuela (Venezuela)

June 30, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-4

France 🇫🇷
Mbappé ⚽ 45', 74'
Barcola ⚽ 53'

3-0
[Report 6]

Sweden 🇸🇪

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Attendance: 80,663
Referee: Danny Makkellie (Netherlands)

June 30, 2026
8:00 p.m. UTC-6^[X]

Mexico 🇲🇽
Quiñones ⚽ 22'
Jiménez ⚽ 31'

2-0
[Report 7]

Ecuador 🇪🇨

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
Attendance: 80,824
Referee: Slavko Vinčić (Slovenia)

July 1, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-4

England 🇬🇧
Kane ⚽ 75', 86'

2-1
[Report 8]

DR Congo 🇨🇩
Cipenga ⚽ 7'

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Attendance: 68,239
Referee: Adham Makhadmeh (Jordan)

July 1, 2026
1:00 p.m. UTC-7

Belgium 🇧🇪
Lukaku ⚽ 86'
Tielemans ⚽ 89', 120+5' (pen.)

3-2 (a.e.t.)
[Report 9]

Senegal 🇸🇳
Diarra ⚽ 25'
I. Sarr ⚽ 51'

Lumen Field, Seattle
Attendance: 66,925
Referee: Saíd Martínez (Honduras)

July 1, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-7

United States 🇺🇸
Balogun ⚽ 45'
Tillman ⚽ 82'

2-0
[Report 10]

Bosnia and Herzegovina 🇸🇦

Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara
Attendance: 68,827
Referee: Raphael Claus (Brazil)

July 2, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-7

Spain 
Oyarzabal ⚽ 36', 89'
Porro ⚽ 66'

3-0
[Report 11]

 **Austria**

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
Attendance: 70,492
Referee: Glenn Nyberg (Sweden)

July 2, 2026
7:00 p.m. UTC-4

Portugal 
Ronaldo ⚽ 68' (pen.)
Ramos ⚽ 90+4'

2-1
[Report 12]

 **Croatia**
Perišić ⚽ 53'

BMO Field, Toronto
Attendance: 43,036
Referee: Espen Eskås (Norway)

July 2, 2026
8:00 p.m. UTC-7

Switzerland 
Embolo ⚽ 10'
Ndoye ⚽ 46'

2-0
[Report 13]

 **Algeria**

BC Place, Vancouver
Attendance: 52,497
Referee: Yael Falcón (Argentina)

July 3, 2026
1:00 p.m. UTC-5

Australia 
Hany ⚽ 55' (o.g.)

Souttar 
Irvine 
Mabil 
Herrington 

1-1 (a.e.t.)
[Report 14]
Penalties
2-4

 **Egypt**
Ashour ⚽ 13'

 Saber
 Rabia
 Salah
 Abdelmaguid

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
Attendance: 70,244
Referee: Gustavo Tejera (Uruguay)

July 3, 2026
6:00 p.m. UTC-4

Argentina 
Messi ⚽ 29'
Li. Martínez ⚽ 92'
Diney ⚽ 111' (o.g.)

3-2 (a.e.t.)
[Report 15]

 **Cape Verde**
D. Duarte ⚽ 59'
Lopes Cabral ⚽ 103'

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
Attendance: 64,478
Referee: Drew Fischer (Canada)

July 3, 2026
8:30 p.m. UTC-5

Colombia 
J. Arias ⚽ 14'

1-0
[Report 16]

 **Ghana**

Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
Attendance: 69,045
Referee: Clément Turpin (France)

Round of 16

July 4, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-5

Canada 🇨🇦

0-3

[Report 17]

🇲🇴 Morocco

Ounahi ⚽ 50', 82'

Rahimi ⚽ 90+8'

NRG Stadium, Houston
Attendance: 68,777
Referee: Michael Oliver (England)

July 4, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-4

Paraguay 🇵🇷

0-1

[Report 18]

🇫🇷 France

Mbappé ⚽ 70' (pen.)

Lincoln Financial Field, Philadelphia
Attendance: 68,324
Referee: Ilgiz Tantashev (Uzbekistan)

July 5, 2026
4:00 p.m. UTC-4

Brazil 🇧🇷

Neymar ⚽ 90+10' (pen.)

1-2

[Report 19]

🇳🇴 Norway

Haaland ⚽ 79', 90'

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Attendance: 80,663
Referee: Ismail Elfath (United States)

July 5, 2026
7:00 p.m. UTC-6^[Y]

Mexico 🇲🇽

Quiñones ⚽ 42'

Jiménez ⚽ 69' (pen.)

2-3

[Report 20]

🇬🇧 England

Bellingham ⚽ 36', 38'

Kane ⚽ 60' (pen.)

Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
Attendance: 80,824
Referee: Alireza Faghani (Australia)

July 6, 2026
2:00 p.m. UTC-5

Portugal 🇵🇹

0-1

[Report 21]

🇪🇸 Spain

Merino ⚽ 90+1'

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
Attendance: 70,649
Referee: Anthony Taylor (England)

July 6, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC-7

United States 🇺🇸

Tillman ⚽ 31'

1-4

[Report 22]

🇧🇪 Belgium

De Ketelaere ⚽ 9', 33'

Vanaken ⚽ 57'

Lukaku ⚽ 90+3'

Lumen Field, Seattle
Attendance: 66,925
Referee: Adham Makhadmeh (Jordan)

July 7, 2026
12:00 p.m. UTC-4

Argentina 🇦🇷

Romero ⚽ 79'

Messi ⚽ 83'

Fernández ⚽ 90+2'

3-2

[Report 23]

🇪🇬 Egypt

Ibrahim ⚽ 15'

Ziko ⚽ 67'

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Attendance: 68,239
Referee: [François Letexier](#) (France)

July 7, 2026
1:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

Switzerland 	0–0 (a.e.t.) [Report 24]	 Colombia
Penalties		
4–3		
Khaka 		 Quintero
Amdouni 		 Sánchez
Akanji 		 Campaz
Itten 		 Hernández
Vargas 		 Díaz

BC Place, Vancouver
Attendance: 52,497
Referee: [Iván Barton](#) (El Salvador)

Quarterfinals

July 9, 2026
4:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

France 	2–0 [Report 25]	 Morocco
Mbappé  60'		
Dembélé  66'		

Gillette Stadium, Foxborough
Attendance: 63,811
Referee: [Facundo Tello](#) (Argentina)

July 10, 2026
12:00 p.m. [UTC-7](#)

Spain 	2–1 [Report 26]	 Belgium
Fabián  30'		De Ketelaere  41'
Merino  88'		

SoFi Stadium, Inglewood
Attendance: 70,492
Referee: [Michael Oliver](#) (England)

July 11, 2026
5:00 p.m. [UTC-4](#)

Norway 	1–2 (a.e.t.) [Report 27]	 England
Schjelderup  36'		Bellingham  45+2', 93'

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
Attendance: 64,478
Referee: [Clément Turpin](#) (France)

July 11, 2026
8:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

Argentina 	3–1 (a.e.t.) [Report 28]	 Switzerland
Mac Allister  10'		Ndoye  67'
Alvarez  112'		
La. Martínez  120+1'		

Arrowhead Stadium, Kansas City
Attendance: 69,045
Referee: [João Pinheiro](#) (Portugal)

Semifinals

July 14, 2026
2:00 p.m. [UTC-5](#)

France 

0–2
[Report 29]

 **Spain**
Oyarzabal ⚽ 22' (pen.)
Porro ⚽ 58'

AT&T Stadium, Arlington
Attendance: 70,176
Referee: Iván Barton (El Salvador)

July 15, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC–4

England 
Gordon ⚽ 55'

1–2
[Report 30]

 **Argentina**
Fernández ⚽ 85'
La. Martínez ⚽ 90+2'

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta
Attendance: 68,239
Referee: Ismail Elfath (United States)

Match for third place

July 18, 2026
5:00 p.m. UTC–4

France 
Mbappé ⚽ 48', 66'
Barcola ⚽ 54'
Dembélé ⚽ 90+6'

4–6
[Report 31]

 **England**
Rice ⚽ 3'
Konsa ⚽ 18'
Saka ⚽ 37', 45+1', 87' (pen.)
Bellingham ⚽ 90+8'

Hard Rock Stadium, Miami Gardens
Attendance: 64,478
Referee: Jesús Valenzuela (Venezuela)

Final

July 19, 2026
3:00 p.m. UTC–4

Spain 
Torres ⚽ 106'

1–0 (a.e.t.)
[Report 32]

 **Argentina**

MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford
Attendance: 80,663
Referee: Slavko Vinčić (Slovenia)

Statistics

Goalscorers

There were 308 goals scored in 104 matches, for an average of 2.96 goals per match.^[142]

10 goals

-  Kylian Mbappé

8 goals

-  Lionel Messi

7 goals

-  Jude Bellingham

-  Erling Haaland

6 goals

-  Harry Kane

-  Ousmane Dembélé

5 goals

-  [Mikel Oyarzabal](#)

4 goals

-  [Vinícius Júnior](#)
-  [Julián Quiñones](#)

3 goals

-  [Lautaro Martínez](#)
-  [Charles De Ketelaere](#)
-  [Romelu Lukaku](#)
-  [Matheus Cunha](#)
-  [Jonathan David](#)
-  [Yoane Wissa](#)
-  [Bukayo Saka](#)
-  [Bradley Barcola](#)
-  [Kai Havertz](#)

2 goals

-  [Riyad Mahrez](#)
-  [Enzo Fernández](#)
-  [Marko Arnautović](#)
-  [Youri Tielemans](#)
-  [Leandro Trossard](#)
-  [Ermin Mahmić](#)
-  [Cyle Larin](#)
-  [Daniel Muñoz](#)
-  [Emam Ashour](#)
-  [Mostafa Ziko](#)
-  [Ramin Rezaeian](#)
-  [Amad Diallo](#)
-  [Nicolas Pépé](#)
-  [Daichi Kamada](#)
-  [Ayase Ueda](#)

1 goal

-  [Rafik Belghali](#)
-  [Nadhir Benbouali](#)
-  [Amine Gouiri](#)
-  [Julián Álvarez](#)
-  [Giovani Lo Celso](#)
-  [Alexis Mac Allister](#)
-  [Lisandro Martínez](#)
-  [Cristian Romero](#)
-  [Nestory Irankunda](#)
-  [Connor Metcalfe](#)
-  [Saša Kalajdžić](#)
-  [Marcel Sabitzer](#)
-  [Romano Schmid](#)
-  [Kevin De Bruyne](#)
-  [Alexis Saelemaekers](#)
-  [Hans Vanaken](#)
-  [Kerim Alajbegović](#)
-  [Jovo Lukić](#)
-  [Casemiro](#)
-  [Gabriel Martinelli](#)
-  [Neymar](#)
-  [Promise David](#)
-  [Stephen Eustáquio](#)

-  [Ismaila Sarr](#)

-  [Deniz Undav](#)
-  [Raúl Jiménez](#)
-  [Ismael Saibari](#)
-  [Brian Brobbey](#)
-  [Cody Gakpo](#)
-  [Elijah Just](#)
-  [Cristiano Ronaldo](#)
-  [Johan Manzambi](#)
-  [Folarin Balogun](#)

-  [Azzedine Ounahi](#)
-  [Soufiane Rahimi](#)
-  [Crysencio Summerville](#)
-  [Habib Diarra](#)
-  [Pape Gueye](#)
-  [Mikel Merino](#)
-  [Pedro Porro](#)
-  [Yasin Ayari](#)
-  [Anthony Elanga](#)
-  [Breel Embolo](#)
-  [Dan Ndoye](#)
-  [Rubén Vargas](#)
-  [Malik Tillman](#)
-  [Maximiliano Araújo](#)

-  [Nathan Saliba](#)
-  [Deroy Duarte](#)
-  [Sidny Lopes Cabral](#)
-  [Kevin Pina](#)
-  [Hélio Varela](#)
-  [Jhon Arias](#)
-  [Jaminton Campaz](#)
-  [Luis Díaz](#)
-  [Martin Baturina](#)
-  [Ante Budimir](#)
-  [Petar Musa](#)
-  [Ivan Perišić](#)
-  [Petar Sučić](#)
-  [Nikola Vlašić](#)
-  [Livano Comenencia](#)
-  [Ladislav Krejčí](#)
-  [Michal Sadílek](#)
-  [Brian Cipenga](#)
-  [Fiston Mayele](#)
-  [Nilson Angulo](#)
-  [Gonzalo Plata](#)
-  [Yasser Ibrahim](#)
-  [Mahmoud Saber](#)

-  [Mohamed Salah](#)
-  [Trézéguet](#)
-  [Anthony Gordon](#)
-  [Ezri Konsa](#)
-  [Marcus Rashford](#)
-  [Declan Rice](#)
-  [Désiré Doué](#)
-  [Nathaniel Brown](#)
-  [Jamal Musiala](#)
-  [Felix Nmecha](#)
-  [Leroy Sané](#)
-  [Nico Schlotterbeck](#)
-  [Derrick Luckassen](#)
-  [Caleb Yirenkyi](#)
-  [Wilson Isidor](#)
-  [Mohammad Mohebi](#)
-  [Aymen Hussein](#)
-  [Franck Kessié](#)
-  [Junya Itō](#)
-  [Daizen Maeda](#)
-  [Keito Nakamura](#)
-  [Kaishū Sano](#)
-  [Ali Olwan](#)
-  [Nizar Al-Rashdan](#)
-  [Musa Al-Taamari](#)
-  [Mateo Chávez](#)
-  [Álvaro Fidalgo](#)
-  [Luis Romo](#)
-  [Issa Diop](#)
-  [Achraf Hakimi](#)
-  [Gessime Yassine](#)
-  [Virgil van Dijk](#)
-  [Jan Paul van Hecke](#)
-  [Finn Surman](#)
-  [Thelo Aasgaard](#)
-  [Antonio Nusa](#)
-  [Leo Østigård](#)
-  [Marcus Holmgren Pedersen](#)

1 own goal

-  [Cameron Burgess](#) (against United States)
-  [Diney](#) (against Argentina)
-  [Aymen Hussein](#) (against Norway)
-  [Yazan Al-Arab](#) (against Austria)
-  [Yassine Bounou](#) (against Haiti)
-  [Damián Bobadilla](#) (against United States)

2 own goals

-  [Mohamed Hany](#) (against Belgium and Australia)

Discipline

A player or team official was automatically suspended for the next match of the tournament for the following offenses:^[139]

- Receiving a red card (red card suspensions could be extended for serious offenses).
- Receiving two yellow cards in the tournament.^[Z] This yellow card count was reset after the completion of the group stage and again after the quarterfinals.^[143] Resets did not apply to suspensions; a player whose yellow card count reached two in the match immediately before a reset was still suspended for the next match.^[144]

-  [Andreas Schjelderup](#)
-  [Julio Enciso](#)
-  [Matías Galarza](#)
-  [Maurício](#)
-  [Rafael Leão](#)
-  [Nuno Mendes](#)
-  [João Neves](#)
-  [Gonçalo Ramos](#)
-  [Hassan Al-Haydos](#)
-  [Abdulah Al-Amri](#)
-  [John McGinn](#)
-  [Ibrahim Mbaye](#)
-  [Iliman Ndiaye](#)
-  [Thapelo Maseko](#)
-  [Teboho Mokoena](#)
-  [Hwang In-beom](#)
-  [Oh Hyeon-gyu](#)
-  [Álex Baena](#)
-  [Fabián Ruiz](#)
-  [Ferran Torres](#)
-  [Lamine Yamal](#)
-  [Viktor Gyökeres](#)
-  [Alexander Isak](#)
-  [Mattias Svanberg](#)
-  [Granit Xhaka](#)
-  [Hazem Mastouri](#)
-  [Omar Rekik](#)
-  [Kaan Ayhan](#)
-  [Arda Güler](#)
-  [Barış Alper Yılmaz](#)
-  [Sebastian Berhalter](#)
-  [Alex Freeman](#)
-  [Giovanni Reyna](#)
-  [Auston Trusty](#)
-  [Agustín Canobbio](#)
-  [Abbosbek Fayzullaev](#)
-  [Eldor Shomurodov](#)

-  [Mahmud Abunada](#) (against Bosnia and Herzegovina)
-  [Mohamed Manai](#) (against Canada)
-  [Hassan Al-Tambakti](#) (against Spain)
-  [Miro Muheim](#) (against Qatar)
-  [Ellyes Skhiri](#) (against Netherlands)
-  [Abduvohid Nematov](#) (against Portugal)

During qualification for the World Cup, Cristiano Ronaldo was sent off for violent conduct in Portugal's penultimate match against the Republic of Ireland, with such an offense typically resulting in a ban of at least two matches. Ronaldo was handed a three-match ban, though the final two matches of the ban were suspended for a one-year probationary period, making him eligible to appear in Portugal's opening World Cup match.^[145] On May 8, 2026, the Bureau of the FIFA Council amended the tournament regulations so that pending one- or two-match suspensions resulting from red cards for two yellow cards, denying an obvious goal-scoring opportunity, or serious foul play during qualification would no longer be carried forward to the final competition.^[146] This exempted Argentina's Nicolás Otamendi, Ecuador's Moisés Caicedo, and Qatar's Tarek Salman from serving their qualifying-round suspensions during the tournament, with the bans to instead be served in a subsequent competition.^[147]

During the round of 32, United States player Folarin Balogun was sent off, and was expected to be banned for the forthcoming round of 16 game against Belgium. Following lobbying from U.S. president Donald Trump,^[148] FIFA suspended the ban.^[149] The Royal Belgian Football Association, Belgium manager Rudi Garcia, and UEFA were critical of the decision.^{[150][151]}

Following the full-time whistle in the final, Argentina player Leandro Paredes was involved in altercations with Spain players Eric García and Gavi. While FIFA initially reported a red card for these incidents, the organization later confirmed that Paredes was not punished at the time.^[152]

The following suspensions were accumulated during the tournament:^{[153][154]}

Tournament suspensions for players and team officials

Player	Offense(s)	Suspension(s)
 <u>Sphephelo Sithole</u>	 in <u>Group A</u> vs <u>Mexico</u> (matchday 1; June 11)	<u>Group A</u> vs <u>Czech Republic</u> (matchday 2; June 18)
 <u>Themba Zwane</u>	 in <u>Group A</u> vs <u>Mexico</u> (matchday 1; June 11)	<u>Group A</u> vs <u>Czech Republic</u> (matchday 2; June 18) <u>Group A</u> vs <u>South Korea</u> (matchday 3; June 24) <u>Round of 32</u> vs <u>Canada</u> (June 28) ^[155]
 <u>César Montes</u>	 in <u>Group A</u> vs <u>South Africa</u> (matchday 1; June 11)	<u>Group A</u> vs <u>South Korea</u> (matchday 2; June 18)
 <u>Teboho Mokoena</u>	 in <u>Group A</u> vs <u>Mexico</u> (matchday 1; June 11)  in <u>Group A</u> vs <u>Czech Republic</u> (matchday 2; June 18)	<u>Group A</u> vs <u>South Korea</u> (matchday 3; June 24)
 <u>Tarik Muharemović</u>	 in <u>Group B</u> vs <u>Switzerland</u> (matchday 2; June 18)	<u>Group B</u> vs <u>Qatar</u> (matchday 3; June 24)
 <u>Homam Ahmed</u>	 in <u>Group B</u> vs <u>Canada</u> (matchday 2; June 18)	<u>Group B</u> vs <u>Bosnia and Herzegovina</u> (matchday 3; June 24)
 <u>Assim Madibo</u>	 in <u>Group B</u> vs <u>Canada</u> (matchday 2; June 18)	<u>Group B</u> vs <u>Bosnia and Herzegovina</u> (matchday 3; June 24) <i>Last 4 matches of suspension to be served outside this tournament</i> ^[156]
 <u>Miguel Almirón</u>	 in <u>Group D</u> vs <u>Turkey</u> (matchday 2; June 19)	<u>Group D</u> vs <u>Australia</u> (matchday 3; June 25)
 <u>Nathan Ngoy</u>	 in <u>Group G</u> vs <u>Iran</u> (matchday 2; June 21)	<u>Group G</u> vs <u>New Zealand</u> (matchday 3; June 26)
 <u>Sidny Lopes Cabral</u>	 in <u>Group H</u> vs <u>Spain</u> (matchday 1; June 15)  in <u>Group H</u> vs <u>Uruguay</u> (matchday 2; June 21)	<u>Group H</u> vs <u>Saudi Arabia</u> (matchday 3; June 26)
 <u>Diego Gómez</u>	 in <u>Group D</u> vs <u>United States</u> (matchday 1; June 12)  in <u>Group D</u> vs <u>Australia</u> (matchday 3; June 25)	<u>Round of 32</u> vs <u>Germany</u> (June 29)
 <u>Rebin Sulaka</u>	 in <u>Group I</u> vs <u>Senegal</u> (matchday 3; June 26)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i>
 <u>Agustín Canobbio</u>	 in <u>Group H</u> vs <u>Spain</u> (matchday 3; June 26)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i>
 <u>Mohanad Lasheen</u>	 in <u>Group G</u> vs <u>New Zealand</u> (matchday 2; June 21)  in <u>Group G</u> vs <u>Iran</u> (matchday 3; June 26)	<u>Round of 32</u> vs <u>Australia</u> (July 3)
 <u>Piero Hincapié</u>	 in <u>Round of 32</u> vs <u>Mexico</u> (June 30)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i>
 <u>Folarin Balogun</u>	 in <u>Round of 32</u> vs <u>Bosnia and Herzegovina</u> (July 1)	<i>Ban suspended</i> ^[149]
 <u>Jarell Quansah</u>	 in <u>Round of 16</u> vs <u>Mexico</u> (July 5)	<u>Quarterfinals</u> vs <u>Norway</u> (July 11) <u>Semifinals</u> vs <u>Argentina</u> (July 15) ^[157]
 <u>Saafan El-Sagheer</u> (goalkeeping coach)	 in <u>Round of 16</u> vs <u>Argentina</u> (July 7)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i> ^[158]
 <u>Breel Embolo</u>	  in <u>Quarterfinals</u> vs <u>Argentina</u> (July 11)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i>
 <u>Enzo Fernández</u>	  in <u>Final</u> vs <u>Spain</u> (July 19)	<i>Suspension to be served outside this tournament</i>

Tournament ranking

Per statistical convention in soccer, matches decided in extra time are counted as wins and losses, while matches decided by penalty shootouts are counted as draws.

Pos	Grp	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Final result
1	H	 Spain	8	7	1	0	14	1	+13	22	Champion
2	J	 Argentina	8	7	0	1	19	8	+11	21	Runner-up
3	L	 England	8	6	1	1	20	12	+8	19	Third place
4	I	 France	8	6	0	2	20	10	+10	18	Fourth place
5	I	 Norway	6	4	0	2	13	11	+2	12	Eliminated in quarterfinals
6	G	 Belgium	6	3	2	1	14	7	+7	11	
7	C	 Morocco	6	3	2	1	10	6	+4	11	
7	B	 Switzerland	6	3	2	1	10	6	+4	11	
9	A	 Mexico (H)	5	4	0	1	10	3	+7	12	Eliminated in round of 16
10	K	 Colombia	5	3	2	0	5	1	+4	11	
11	C	 Brazil	5	3	1	1	10	4	+6	10	
12	D	 United States (H)	5	3	0	2	11	8	+3	9	
13	K	 Portugal	5	2	2	1	8	3	+5	8	
14	B	 Canada (H)	5	2	1	2	9	6	+3	7	
15	G	 Egypt	5	1	3	1	8	7	+1	6	
16	D	 Paraguay	5	1	2	2	3	6	-3	5	
17	F	 Netherlands	4	2	2	0	11	5	+6	8	Eliminated in round of 32
18	E	 Germany	4	2	1	1	11	5	+6	7	
19	E	 Ivory Coast	4	2	0	2	5	4	+1	6	
20	L	 Croatia	4	2	0	2	6	7	-1	6	
21	F	 Japan	4	1	2	1	8	5	+3	5	
22	D	 Australia	4	1	2	1	3	3	0	5	
23	K	 DR Congo	4	1	1	2	5	5	0	4	
24	L	 Ghana	4	1	1	2	2	3	-1	4	
25	E	 Ecuador	4	1	1	2	2	4	-2	4	
25	A	 South Africa	4	1	1	2	2	4	-2	4	
27	F	 Sweden	4	1	1	2	7	10	-3	4	
28	J	 Austria	4	1	1	2	6	9	-3	4	
29	B	 Bosnia and Herzegovina	4	1	1	2	5	8	-3	4	
30	J	 Algeria	4	1	1	2	5	9	-4	4	
31	I	 Senegal	4	1	0	3	10	9	+1	3	
32	H	 Cape Verde	4	0	3	1	4	5	-1	3	
33	G	 Iran	3	0	3	0	3	3	0	3	Eliminated in group stage
34	A	 South Korea	3	1	0	2	2	3	-1	3	
35	D	 Turkey	3	1	0	2	3	5	-2	3	
36	C	 Scotland	3	1	0	2	1	4	-3	3	
37	H	 Uruguay	3	0	2	1	3	4	-1	2	
38	H	 Saudi Arabia	3	0	2	1	1	5	-4	2	
39	A	 Czech Republic	3	0	1	2	2	6	-4	1	
40	G	 New Zealand	3	0	1	2	4	10	-6	1	
41	B	 Qatar	3	0	1	2	2	10	-8	1	
42	E	 Curaçao	3	0	1	2	1	9	-8	1	
43	L	 Panama	3	0	0	3	0	4	-4	0	
44	J	 Jordan	3	0	0	3	3	8	-5	0	

45	<u>C</u>	 <u>Haiti</u>	3	0	0	3	2	8	−6	0
46	<u>K</u>	 <u>Uzbekistan</u>	3	0	0	3	2	11	−9	0
47	<u>F</u>	 <u>Tunisia</u>	3	0	0	3	2	12	−10	0
48	<u>I</u>	 <u>Iraq</u>	3	0	0	3	1	12	−11	0

Source: FIFA^{[159][160]}
(H) Hosts

Prize money

In April 2026, FIFA confirmed the prizes for all participating nations. The total distribution of prize money for the expanded tournament was \$871 million, nearly double the amount from the 2022 World Cup. Of this total, \$671 million was allocated for performance-based prizes, with the remaining \$200 million paid out among teams regardless of performance. Each qualified team received preparation money in the amount of \$2.5 million; a team that was eliminated in the group stage would receive a minimum total amount \$12.5 million at the tournament, with the winner receiving a total of \$52.5 million.^{[161][162][163]}

Performance-based prize money

Place	Teams	Amount (in millions)	
		Per team	Total
Champion	1	\$50	\$50
Runner-up	1	\$33	\$33
Third place	1	\$29	\$29
Fourth place	1	\$27	\$27
5th–8th place (quarterfinals)	4	\$19	\$76
9th–16th place (round of 16)	8	\$15	\$120
17th–32nd place (round of 32)	16	\$11	\$176
33rd–48th place (group stage)	16	\$10	\$160
Total	48	\$671	

Awards

The following awards were presented at the end of the tournament.^{[164][165][142]}

- Golden Ball: Awarded to the best overall player of the tournament.
- Golden Boot: Awarded to the tournament's top goal scorer.
- Golden Glove: Awarded to the tournament's best goalkeeper.
- FIFA Young Player Award: Awarded to the best overall player of the tournament born on or after January 1, 2005 (aged 21 or under).
- FIFA Fair Play Trophy: Awarded to the team with the best disciplinary record that reached the knockout stage.

Golden Ball	Silver Ball	Bronze Ball
 <u>Rodri</u>	 <u>Lionel Messi</u>	 <u>Kylian Mbappé</u>
Golden Boot	Silver Boot	Bronze Boot
 <u>Kylian Mbappé</u> 10 goals, 4 assists, 769 minutes played	 <u>Lionel Messi</u> 8 goals, 4 assists, 853 minutes played	 <u>Jude Bellingham</u> 7 goals, 1 assist, 698 minutes played
Golden Glove		
 <u>Unai Simón</u>		
FIFA Young Player Award		
 <u>Pau Cubarsí</u>		
FIFA Fair Play Trophy		
 <u>Netherlands</u>		



Left to right: Young Player Award winner Pau Cubarsí, Golden Ball winner Rodri, and Golden Glove winner Unai Simón.

As in past editions, FIFA.com shortlisted 10 goals for users to vote for the goal of the tournament.^[166] The award was won by Cape Verde's Sidny Lopes Cabral for his equalizing goal in extra time during the round of 32 match against Argentina.^[167]

Additionally, a "Superior Player of the Match" award was presented after each game to the player who delivered the most outstanding performance in, and had the greatest impact on, that match, as decided by a public online vote conducted by FIFA. The award was sponsored by Michelob Ultra.^[168] Muslim players, such as Mohamed Salah and Lamine Yamal, received a brandless trophy, out of respect for Islam's views on alcohol.^{[169][170]}

Outside of the FIFA awards, Messi was named the tournament's best player by the International Federation of Football History and Statistics (IFFHS), who cited his eight goals and four assists across seven appearances as the basis for the distinction.^{[171][172]}

Team of the Tournament

FIFA also invited users of FIFA.com to elect their Dream XI.^{[173][174]}

Goalkeeper	Defenders	Midfielders	Forwards
 <u>Vozinha</u>	 <u>Marc Cucurella</u>  <u>Lisandro Martínez</u>  <u>Dayot Upamecano</u>  <u>Pedro Porro</u>	 <u>Jude Bellingham</u>  <u>Rodri</u>  <u>Michael Olise</u>	 <u>Kylian Mbappé</u>  <u>Erling Haaland</u>  <u>Lionel Messi</u>

Marketing

Branding

The official logo and brand identity of the tournament was unveiled on May 17, 2023, at the Griffith Observatory in Los Angeles, California. The logo's basic form consisted of a stacked "26" with an image of the FIFA World Cup Trophy in front of it. This was the first time that the trophy was depicted in a World Cup emblem as a photo, as opposed to a stylized representation.^{[175][176]} Initial reactions to the logo were largely negative, with many saying that the design felt unfinished or uncreative compared to the logos of past FIFA World Cup tournaments.^{[176][177][178]} The next day, FIFA unveiled brand identities for each host city, which incorporated designs that reflected local landscapes or culture.^{[179][180]}

In March and April 2025, FIFA unveiled a set of 16 posters representing each of the 2026 World Cup host cities. The posters, designed by local artists, were intended to reflect the "distinct identity and heritage" of each city.^{[181][182]} On March 3, 2026, the official poster for the tournament was unveiled. It was created by Carson Ting of Canada, Minerva GM of Mexico, and Hank Willis Thomas of the United States.^[183]

Broadcasting rights

On February 12, 2015, FIFA renewed the United States and Canadian broadcasting rights contracts for Fox Sports (U.S. English), Telemundo Deportes (U.S. Spanish), and Bell Media (Canada) to cover the 2026 World Cup, without accepting any other bids. A report in The New York Times asserted that this extension was intended as compensation for the rescheduling of the 2022 World Cup to November–December rather than its traditional June–July scheduling, as it created considerable conflicts with major professional sports leagues that were normally in their offseasons during the World Cup.^{[184][185][186]}

The International Broadcast Center (IBC) was located at the Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center in Dallas.^{[187][188][189]} Bell Media constructed a broadcast studio at Jack Poole Plaza in Vancouver for the tournament (mirroring an arrangement used by Fox during the 2015 FIFA Women's World Cup), which originated TSN/CTV's coverage from June 11 through July 7 (the final match played in the city).^[190]

On January 8, 2026, FIFA signed a deal to make TikTok a "preferred platform" for World Cup video content. As part of the agreement, broadcasters could stream parts of matches at a dedicated hub on the TikTok app.^[191] FIFA then made a similar "preferred platform" deal with YouTube on March 17, allowing broadcasters to stream select matches in full on their respective YouTube channels, as well



Countdown clock on Paseo de la Reforma, Mexico City in September 2025



Official poster